



Firefox Mobile Privacy Setup (Android + iOS)

1. Install the right version

- **Android:** Use **Firefox** (not “Lite”) from Play Store or F-Droid.
 - Bonus: on Android, extensions *do* work.
 - **iOS:** Apple restricts extensions, but Firefox Focus + DNS-level protection gives similar results.
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ANDROID CONFIGURATION

A. Core Privacy Settings

1. Open Firefox → Menu (☰) → **Settings** → **Privacy and Security**
 - Tracking Protection: **Strict**
 - “Send technical data”: **Off**
 - “Block pop-ups”: **On**
 - “Delete browsing data on quit”: enable and check *History, Cookies, Site Data, Cached Images*
 - “HTTPS-Only Mode”: **Enable in all tabs**
 2. Under **Search**, change to:
 - **DuckDuckGo, Startpage, or Kagi** (avoid Google).
 - Turn off “Show search suggestions”.
 3. Under **Logins and Passwords** → disable “Autofill logins” if you use a password manager (Bitwarden, Proton Pass, etc.).
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B. Install Add-ons (Android only)

Go to **Menu** → **Add-ons** → **Recommended** and install:

Add-on	Purpose
uBlock Origin	Ad, tracker, and malware blocking (same filters as desktop).
Privacy Badger	Learns and blocks new trackers.
NoScript (<i>optional</i>)	Blocks active code; great for banking, Tor-like browsing.
ClearURLs	Removes tracking parameters (utm_, fbclid, etc.) from links.
Decentraleyes / LocalCDN	Blocks external CDN tracking, speeds up sites.

uBlock setup:

Tap the uBlock icon → *Settings* → *Filter lists* → Enable:

- EasyList + EasyPrivacy
- uBlock filters – Annoyances
- Malware domains
- Peter Lowe's List
Then enable *I am an advanced user* (under Settings).

C. Network Protection

Combine Firefox with a **private DNS service** at system level:

- Android → Settings → Network → **Private DNS** → choose **dns.nextdns.io/yourid** or **dns.controld.com/xxxx**.
This blocks trackers before your browser even sees them.

(That single step cuts mobile tracking traffic by ~70%.)

D. Optional Enhancements

- **Containers aren't supported on Android**, but you can use **Profiles** (separate Firefox installs for Work vs Personal).
 - Install **Bitwarden** or **Proton Pass** for encrypted credentials.
 - Disable Android's **Advertising ID**: Settings → Privacy → Ads → *Delete advertising ID*.
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iOS CONFIGURATION

Because Apple limits Firefox extensions, privacy defense relies on layering:

A. Firefox Focus (companion browser)

Install **Firefox Focus** from the App Store.
It automatically:

- Blocks ads and trackers,
- Clears all data on exit,
- Has no extensions to misbehave.

Use it as your default for *quick, private searches and link openings*.

B. Harden main Firefox

1. Settings → **Privacy** → **Enhanced Tracking Protection** → **Strict**
2. **HTTPS-Only Mode**: On
3. **Delete browsing data on quit**: On
4. **Search**: switch to DuckDuckGo or Startpage.
5. Turn off telemetry (Usage Data, Studies, Crash Reports).

C. DNS layer

- iOS → Settings → **Wi-Fi** → **(info icon)** → **Configure DNS** → **Manual** → use:
 - NextDNS, ControlD, or AdGuard DNS (for system-wide filtering).
 - Combine with a reputable VPN (Proton, IVPN, Mullvad) for IP masking.
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Usage Patterns

- **Firefox (main)**: trusted, logged-in sites (banking, work).
 - **Firefox Focus**: anonymous browsing or link previews.
 - **Private DNS**: always-on background shield.
 - **VPN**: for hostile Wi-Fi or travel.
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Maintenance Habits

- Weekly: Clear site data (Settings → Delete browsing data).
- Monthly: Update filter lists in uBlock.
- Quarterly: Reset advertising ID and recheck DNS still active.